# Passive voice: the core.

Start with the receiver of the action. Change be; keep the past participle (V3).

## The basic switch

**A technician repaired the robot.** -> **The robot was repaired (by a technician).**
Active: the subject does the action. Passive: the subject receives it. The tense stays Past Simple.

| Timeline | Passive form | Example |
|---|---|---|
| **Present Simple** | am/is/are + V3 | The labels are checked daily. |
| **Present Continuous** | am/is/are being + V3 | The robot is being repaired now. |
| **Past Simple** | was/were + V3 | The robot was repaired yesterday. |
| **Past Continuous** | was/were being + V3 | It was being repaired when I arrived. |
| **Present Perfect** | have/has been + V3 | It has already been repaired. |
| **Past Perfect** | had been + V3 | It had been repaired before the tour. |

## Questions and negatives

Move the **first auxiliary** before the subject:
**Has** it **been repaired**?
**Was** it **being repaired**?

Add **not** after that auxiliary:
It **has not been repaired**.
It **was not being repaired**.

## Do we need the agent?

Use **by + agent** if the identity matters:
The portrait was painted **by Lee**.

Omit an unknown, obvious, or unimportant agent.
Name responsibility when it matters: **The supplier mislabelled it.**

# Passive voice: the future.

An action, an earlier plan, or a completed result before a future viewpoint?

| Timeline | Passive form | Example |
|---|---|---|
| **Future Simple** | will be + V3 | It will be unveiled tomorrow. |
| **Going to** | am/is/are going to be + V3 | The entrance is going to be redesigned. |
| **Future Perfect** | will have been + V3 | By Friday, it will have been repaired. |

## Questions

**Will** it **be unveiled** tomorrow?

**When is** it **going to be unveiled**?

**Will** it **have been repaired** by Friday?

## Negatives

It **will not / won't be unveiled** tomorrow.

It **is not / isn't going to be unveiled** tomorrow.

It **will not / won't have been repaired** by Friday.

## Been is not enough: read the next word.

**Active duration:** By Friday, the team **will have been restoring** it for a week.
**Passive result:** By Friday, it **will have been restored**.
The first highlights the process; the second promises completion. They are not equivalent.
**Time clause:** By the time the doors **open**, it will have been repaired.

## Use a natural sentence, not a mechanical conversion.

**Check the verb:** the visitors arrived; an accident happened. Arrive and happen do not form passives in these meanings.
**Future Continuous passive:** will be being repaired is grammatical but cumbersome. Usually prefer **The technicians will be repairing it** or **It will be under repair**.
**Perfect continuous passive:** forms such as will have been being restored are very uncommon. Keep the duration message active: **The team will have been restoring it for a week.**

Reference: British Council: Passives; Cambridge: Passive forms. Examples written for this guide.